LECTURE ONE – HANDOUT ONE

1. **ARTICLES**
2. **ACADEMIC WRITING**

ARTICLES

The – Definite article

A An – Indefinite articles

I saw the man on the road- certain/sure

I saw a man on the road – uncertainties

Grammar rule 1

When you have a single, **countable** English noun, you must always have an article before it. We cannot say "please pass me pen", we must say "please pass me **the** pen" or "please pass me **a** pen" or "please pass me **your** pen".

Nouns in English can also be uncountable. Uncountable nouns can be concepts, such as 'life', 'happiness' and so on, or materials and substances, such as 'coffee', or 'wood'.

Quantifiers/ determiners – some any lot of

Grammar rule 2

Uncountable nouns don't use **'a'** or **'an'**. This is because you can't count them. For example, advice is an uncountable noun. You can't say "he gave

me an advice", but you can say "he gave me **some** advice", or "he gave me **a piece of** advice".

Some, any, a lot of , few
Information
Advice

Boys' school

Some nouns can be both countable and uncountable. For example, we say "coffee" meaning the product, but we say "**a** coffee" when asking for one cup of coffee.

Pronunciation Practise

The moon
The ice cream

Grammar rule 3

A - words starting with consonants/sound of consonants

An- starting with vowels/ vowel sounds a e I O U – IPA

Agree/ achieve / appreciate / accept/ appropriate

A university vs An umbrella

Yuniversity

Umma muha

Muuha Mom awesome

a Yuniversity - Mumbai

~~An~~ unique person / a unique person

A unicorn

Yuni

A Hour / an hour

Our a horse

Psychology

Psychic

Bri~~d~~ge o

An/a honest person awesome

Awe ball vs ball bawl

Meat vs meet

Elephant

A enna

1. ……..~~The~~ Society is the best teacher. It gives you the most pragmatic experience to live [a] life

You can use **‘the’** to make general things specific. You can use **‘the’** with any type of noun – plural or singular, countable or uncountable.
“Please pass me **a** pen” – any pen.
“Please pass me **the** pen” – the one that we can both see.
“Children grow up quickly” – children in general.
“**The** children I know grow up quickly” – not all children, just the ones I know.
“Poetry can be beautiful”- poetry in general.
“**The** poetry of Hopkins is beautiful” – I’m only talking about the poetry Hopkins wrote.

More uses of English articles

Here are some more rules for when we use English articles “a/an” and “the” – or when we omit the article:

RIVERS, MOUNTAIN RANGES, SEAS, OCEANS AND GEOGRAPHIC ALL USE '**THE**'.

For example, "**The** Thames", "**The** Alps", "**The** Atlantic Ocean", "**The** Middle East". The United kingdom

Unique things have **'the'**.

For example, "**the** sun", "**the** moon".

Some institutional buildings don't have an article if you visit them for the reason these buildings exist. But if you go to the building for another reason, you must use **'the'**.

"Her husband is in prison." – He went to prison (He's a prisoner.)

"She goes to **the** prison to see him once a month."

"My son is in school."/My son goes to school (He's a student.)

"I'm going to **the** school to see the head master."

"She's in hospital at the moment." (She's ill.)

"Her husband goes to **the** hospital to see her every afternoon."

Musical instruments use ‘**the**‘.

“She plays **the** piano.”

Sports don’t have an article.

“He plays football.”

Illnesses don’t have an article.

“He’s got appendicitis.”

But we say “**a** cold” and “**a** headache”.

Jobs use **‘a’**.

“I’m **a** teacher.”

COUNTRIES

We don’t use **‘a’** if the country is singular. “He lives in England.”

But if the country’s name has a “plural” meaning, we use **‘the’**.

“**The** People’s Republic of China”, “**The** Netherlands”, “**The** United States of America”.

Continents, towns and streets don’t have an article.

“Africa”, “New York”, “Church Street”.

Theatres, cinemas and hotels have **‘the’**.

“**The** Odeon”, “**The** Almeira”, “**The** Hilton”.

Abbreviations use **‘the’**. (Initialisms)

“**the** UN”, “**the** USA”, “**the** IMF”.

We use **‘the’** before **classes of people.**

“**the** rich”, “**the** poor”, “**the** British”.

The Tamil people = incorrect

The Tamils = Correct

The Canadian people = Wrong

The Canadians = Correct

ENGLISH ARTICLES QUIZ

A famous detective and his deputy - (This story is based on a famous joke.)

1. ……. famous detective and his deputy were walking in …… forest.
2. …….forest was dark and a little bit frightening.
3. Soon it began to get dark. But luckily they had ____tent with them.
4. They decided to stay __the___ night.
5. They put up their tent under _____ stars and went to sleep.
6. Then, in the middle of the night, there was _____ loud noise.
7. _____ detective woke up.
8. He looked up at _____ sky.
9. Then he woke up _____ deputy and asked, "What can you see?"
10. The deputy replied, "I see millions and millions of _____ stars."
11. The detective asked, "And what is your _____opinion about that?"

12. The deputy replied, 'Well, if there are millions of stars, and if even a few of those have _____ planets, "
13. "It's quite likely there are some planets like _____ Earth out there."
14. "If there are _____ few planets like Earth out there,"
15. "there might also be _____ life."
16. The detective replied, "You idiot! It means that somebody stole _____ tent."

Source: https://www.english-at-home.com/grammar/articles/#

A famous detective and his deputy - (This story is based on a famous joke.)

17. A famous detective and his deputy were walking in a forest.
18. The forest was dark and a little bit frightening.
19. Soon it began to get dark. But luckily they had __a___tent with them.
20. They decided to stay __the___ night.
21. They put up their tent under _____ stars and went to sleep.
22. Then, in the middle of the night, there was _____ loud noise.
23. _____ Detective woke up.
24. He looked up at _____ sky.
25. Then he woke up _____ deputy and asked, "What can you see?"
26. The deputy replied, "I see millions and millions of _____ stars."
27. The detective asked, "And what is your _____opinion about that?"
28. The deputy replied, 'Well, if there are millions of stars, and if even a few of those have _____ planets, "
29. "It's quite likely there are some planets like _____ Earth out there."
30. "If there are _____ few planets like Earth out there,"
31. "there might also be _____ life."
32. The detective replied, "You idiot! It means that somebody stole _____ tent."

Source: https://www.english-at-home.com/grammar/articles/#

ACADEMIC WRITING - ACTIVITY ONE

Answer the following questions briefly, in your own words.

1. What is academic writing?

……

……

……

……

2. Make 2 sentences each using the following words. 01 for everyday use and 01 for academic use:

   a) discipline b) underline

……
……
……
……

3. Academic writing contains words that are neutral, but they are also rather formal expressions which are not common in everyday use. Give more formal words for the neutral words given below:

   a) in short b) only c) almost

……
……
……

4. Write the most suitable preposition to match the noun.

   a) attempt b) changes, differences

   c) investigation, research d) work, influence

……
……
……
……..……..…